

SEO Quick Checklist 2026

A 30-point checklist to rank higher in Google & AI search.

Technical SEO

- ☐ Site is indexed in Google Search Console
- ☐ XML sitemap submitted and valid
- ☐ Core Web Vitals pass (LCP < 2.5s, FID < 100ms, CLS < 0.1)
- ☐ Mobile-friendly test passes
- ☐ HTTPS enforced with valid SSL
- ☐ No broken links (404s)
- ☐ Canonical tags set correctly
- ☐ robots.txt not blocking important pages

On-Page SEO

- ☐ Title tag under 60 chars with primary keyword
- ☐ Meta description under 160 chars
- ☐ H1 matches page topic
- ☐ Content uses H2/H3 hierarchy
- ☐ Images have alt text
- ☐ Internal links to related content
- ☐ Schema markup added (Article, FAQ, etc.)
- ☐ URL is short and keyword-rich

Content & Authority

- ☐ Content is original and 1,000+ words
- ☐ Targets search intent (informational/navigational/transactional)
- ☐ EEAT signals present (author bio, citations)
- ☐ Outbound links to authoritative sources
- ☐ Content updated within the last 6 months

AI Search Optimization (AEO/GEO)

- ☐ Structured data (FAQ, HowTo, Article schema)
- ☐ Content answers direct questions (featured snippet format)
- ☐ Entity clarity — named entities, brand terms defined
- ☐ Content citable — stats with sources, clear claims
- ☐ LLM-friendly formatting — tables, lists, bold key phrases

Off-Page

lootpaper.xyz — Free tools & resources for makers

- ☐ Backlink profile has 10+ referring domains
- ☐ Anchor text diversity